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United States Patent	12386872
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
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Language detection of user input text for online gaming

Abstract

A user query, such as a user query processed by the online game system, is provided as input into a trained machine learning model. The machine learning model predicts candidate languages of the user query and outputs language confidence scores for the candidate languages. The user query is also matched with stored query data associated with game information in individual language databases for the respective candidate languages. A match scores may be determined based on a certainty of the respective response matches. The match scores and the language confidence scores may be weighted to determine a weighted score. The weighted scores of the response matches are applied to decide which game information retrieved from the identified database is used in forming a response of search results to the user.

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Appl. No.: 18/651020

Filed: April 30, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240330337 A1	Oct. 03, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17967420 20221017 US 11989215 child-doc US 18651020

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G06F16/00** (20190101); **G06F16/3329** (20250101); **G06F16/3332** (20250101); **G06F16/335** (20190101); **G06F40/263** (20200101); **G06F40/56** (20200101); **G06N20/00** (20190101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06F16/3334** (20190101); **G06F16/3329** (20190101); **G06F16/335** (20190101); **G06F40/263** (20200101); **G06F40/56** (20200101); **G06N20/00** (20190101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (16/3334); G06F (16/3329); G06F (16/335); G06F (40/56); G06F (40/263); G06N (20/00)

USPC: 707/748

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation application under 35 U.S.C. § 120 of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/967,420, filed on Oct. 17, 2022 and titled LANGUAGE DETECTION OF USER INPUT TEXT FOR ONLINE GAMING, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/858,467, filed on Apr. 24, 2020 and titled LANGUAGE DETECTION OF USER INPUT TEXT FOR ONLINE GAMING (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,475,054). U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/858,467 and U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/967,420, including any appendices or attachments thereof, are incorporated by reference here in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Online gaming provides an opportunity for player located around the world to participate together, regardless of geographical and language boundaries. Gaming platforms often enable a user to input text, such as a search query, that assists the user in interacting with games. The text inputted into online games typically has distinctive characteristics. Recognizing possible languages of the text may assist in effectively responding to the text.

(2) Machine learning may be leveraged for natural language processing (NLP) to interpret text inputted by a user of an online gaming platform. Algorithms, e.g. predictive models, can be created to learn from empirical data via training and to perform analysis of the user input text. Such artificial intelligence requires clean and relevant data for proper training of the machine learning model in the online gaming context.

SUMMARY

(3) Implementations of this application relate to detecting a language of a user query inputted by a user of online games, by use of a trained machine learning model. The machine learning model is trained with processed text data relevant to online gaming.

(4) In some implementations, a method includes receiving a user query and separating the user query into a plurality of n-grams. At least one candidate language is identified by applying a machine learning model to the plurality of n-grams of the user query. The machine learning model is trained with at least one multilingual text corpus and game-related data. A respective language confidence score for each of the at least one candidate language is determined by applying the machine learning model. The at least one candidate language is used to select at least one language-specific databases to search. A response match is identified in the at least one language-specific databases and a respective match score is determined for each of the response matches. A weighted score is determined by at least the respective language confidence score and the respective match score. The weighted score is used as a basis to determine at least one query language for the user query.

(5) Various implementations and examples of the method are described. For example, in some implementations, the method also includes determining game information associated with the response match in the at least one language-specific game database. A search result to the user query is generated based on the game information. The game information may include webpage information for online games. The search result may include one or more user interface elements that, when activated by a user, links a webpage associated with a respective one of the online games.

(6) In some implementations, user profile information associated with the user query is provided and the at least one query language is further based on user profile information. The respective confidence score may be further determined by identifying one or more segments of the plurality of

n-grams that are relevant to the at least one candidate language. The at least one candidate language may also include an unidentified language and the language-specific game database may include a database associated with unknown languages.

(7) In some implementations, a system is provided that includes a computing device with one or more processors for detecting language of a user query for online games. The computing device also includes logic encoded in one or more tangible media for execution by the one or more processors and when executed operable to perform operations. The operations include receiving a user query and separating the user query into a plurality of n-grams. At least one candidate language is identified by applying a machine learning model to the plurality of n-grams of the user query. The machine learning model is trained with at least one multilingual text corpus and game-related data. A respective confidence score for each of the at least one candidate language is determined by applying the machine learning model. The at least one candidate language is used by the operations to select at least one language-specific databases to search. A response match is identified in the at least one language-specific databases and a respective match score is determined for each of the response match. A weighted score is determined by at least the respective language confidence score and the respective match score. The weighted score is used as a basis by the operations to determine at least one query language for the user query.

(8) Various implementations and examples of the operations performed by the operations are described. For example, in some implementations, the operations also includes determining game information associated with the response match in the at least one language-specific game database. The search result to the user query is generated based on the game information. The game information may include webpage information for online games. The search result may include one or more user interface elements that, when activated by a user, links a webpage associated with a respective one of the online games.

(9) In some implementations, user profile information associated with the user query is provided and the at least one query language is determined by the operations further based on user profile information. The respective confidence score may be further determined by the operations identifying one or more segments of the plurality of n-grams that are relevant to the at least one candidate language. The at least one candidate language may also include an unidentified language and the language-specific game database may include a database associated with unknown languages.

(10) Various implementations and examples of a method of training a machine learning model to identify a language of a user query for online games are described. Text data is received that include at least first text data, associated language labels for the first text data and second text data unlabeled for languages. Associated language labels are determined for the second text data based on a threshold number of a plurality of non-specific language detectors identifying at least one language. Training text data are created by separating the text data into n-grams. The machine learning model is trained to generate at least one candidate language identifier of the user query and a respective language confidence score. Training text data is fed to the machine learning model for training without the associated language labels. The machine learning model outputs predicted language labels. Retraining of the machine learning model may be conducted with discrepancy information between the current predicted language labels and the associated language labels, to update the current predicted language labels. The retraining may be iteratively repeated until the discrepancy information meets a threshold of accuracy.

(11) In some implementations creating the training text data further includes splitting word strings of the text data having a length greater than an upper threshold length, into random word lengths of a predetermined length. In some implementations creating the training text data further includes aggregating word strings of text data having a length shorter than a low threshold length, with related text to create extended strings of words. The training data set may also be created by determining the n-grams that meet a commonality threshold across languages and within

languages. In some implementations, the n-grams may include at least one of: one character, two characters, or three characters.

(12) In some implementations the text data may include at least one collection of game-related data that includes at least one of game titles, chat texts, game source data, or slang terms. In some implementations, a vector that includes respective confidence scores for multiple languages is generated and multiple-language specific databases of the at least one language-specific game database corresponding to the respective confidence scores are searched based on the user query.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosure is illustrated by way of example, and not by way of limitation in the figures in which like reference numerals are used to refer to similar elements.

(2) FIG. 1 is a conceptual diagram illustrating an example environment in which various aspects of evaluating a user query may be implemented in an online game system, in accordance with some implementations.

(3) FIG. 2 is block diagram illustrating elements of an example data processing computing device to pre-process text data and to create training text data for a language analysis system, in accordance with some implementations.

(4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method to train a machine learning model for the language analysis system, in accordance with some implementations.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method to evaluate a user query by applying the machine learning model, in accordance with some implementations.

(6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary computing device for analyzing a user query and providing a search result response, in accordance with some implementations.

(7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of exemplary online game system architecture for a user query to be communicated from a client device to a computing device, the user query to be analyzed and a search result response to be transmitted to the client device, in accordance with some implementations.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Online game systems enable users (e.g. players of games, game developers, etc.) to access games via online gaming platforms, e.g. client computing devices. In some implementations, users may communicate with an online game system or with other users of the online game system by transmitting text messages, e.g., queries, commands, chats, etc., within the online gaming system. For example, user queries may be entered by users to request information and to locate games, such as by game title, keywords, game description, genre, players, developers, game quality, etc. User queries may also be inputted to find particular aspects of a game, such as locating certain players or player groups, virtual items for use in games, e.g. avatar parts, clothing, and accessories, and game developer tools, e.g. packages, decals, audio, and plugins.

(9) In various implementations, the present online game system evaluates a user query and formulates a response that includes a search result to the query. The online game system employs a language analysis system to detect potential languages of a user query and to assist in efficient and reliable searching for results to formulate the response.

(10) Often, user queries entered by users into online gaming platforms are text strings that are shorter in length than an ideal length for typical easy language analysis. For example, the user query may be a string of ten-words, a string of a few words or a couple of words, or a single word. A user query may be in the form of one or more keywords, a phrase, a short sentence, a game title, and the like. A user query in online games may also include unique jargons with distinctive patterns and rules. The user query may be in one or more various languages, e.g. a language specific to a

country or geographic region, a language known by a group of users, or a code. Due to the distinctive text used in online gaming platforms, standard language analysis techniques, such as by NLP, may result in erroneous language predictions when applied to user queries inputted into online gaming platforms. The present language analysis system allows for determinations of potential user query languages, such as by applying a machine learning model that is particularly trained, processing user queries, and determining and weighing scores, all according to the description presented. The online game system enables efficient and resource saving searches of game information in response to the user query, for example, by providing game-related databases dedicated to specific languages and limiting searches for game information to particular language databases that have the most potential to match the user query language. Identifying specific language databases in which to search reduces the need to comb through databases of all languages including unrelated databases to find response matches, thus reducing processing time and computing resources.

(11) Narrowing the search to the language-specific databases of candidate languages may enable use of more meaningful search terms to provide better results. Various languages may apply different rules to interpret search terms, For example, not all languages use spaces between words the same. Also, common words, such as the articles “the” or “a”, may not be considered for searching in a particular language, but may be significant in another language.

(12) Techniques to score and assign weight values employed by the language analysis system, as well as retraining of the machine language model enables greater accuracy and reliability of search results. Furthermore, without the present machine language model trained for text particular to online gaming, there may insufficient information in a terse user query from which standard NLP can deduce a query language.

(13) The user query, such as a user query processed by the online game system, is provided as input into the specifically trained machine learning model. The machine learning model predicts candidate languages of the user query and outputs language confidence scores for the candidate languages. For example, candidate languages associated with confidence scores that meet a confidence threshold may be used to determine which language-specific databases to search. The user query is matched with stored query data associated with game information in individual storage buckets (e.g., databases) for at least some of the respective candidate languages. A match score for each response matches may be determined based on a certainty of the respective response matches. The match scores and the language confidence scores may be weighted to determine a weighted score. The weighted score may be used to determine which search results from the response matches to provide in a response to the user. For example, the search results may be ranked based on the weighted score and a top threshold number of search results may be used in a response to the user query.

(14) The machine learning model of the language analysis system is trained with relevant text data, pre-processed for an online gaming context. Texts related to online gaming platforms are generally unique. Machine learning models benefit from being trained on actual online gaming data to perform with precision in evaluating user queries. Predicted language labels are generated by the machine learning model during training. The language labels may be used as feedback input to update the machine learning model and achieve a target level of accuracy.

(15) In illustration of a usage example of the online game system employing the language analysis system according to one implementation, a player of online gaming system attempts to locate an online game in which she can run her own virtual pizza business. To further illustrate the usage example, FIG. 1 shows an instance of such an online game system **100** that includes a client computing device **102** communicating with a game server **130**.

(16) In the usage example, the player knows that the game relates to the word “tycoon.” The player conducts a search for the game on the client computing device **102** by a user interface **104** on a display screen **106** of the client computing device **102**. The user types a user query **114** into a text

box **110** using keyboard **108**. The user query **114** in this example contains keywords, “pizza” and “el magnate,” the Spanish word for “tycoon” in English. She activates a display element **112** on the user interface **104** to initiate a search for games related to the entered keywords.

(17) The user query **114** is transmitted across network **122** to game server **130**. The game server **130** includes processor **140** that accesses the language analysis system **134** stored in a memory **132** and may perform one or more of the described steps to form a search result response to the user query **114**.

(18) The user query **114** may be processed and inputted into a machine learning model **136** of the language analysis system **134** to determine at least one candidate language of the user query and a confidence score for each candidate language. The machine learning model **136** has been trained with text data that has been pre-processed to adapt the text data to distinctive formats of user queries typical of online gaming. The pre-processing enables the machine learning model **136** to recognize languages from a small number of input words in the user query. The machine learning model **136** may be updated with text data to reach a target level of accuracy.

(19) In the usage example, the search engine **138** determines that a candidate language for the word “el magnate” may be Spanish. Candidate languages for the word “pizza” may be Spanish and may also be English, and/or Italian. The language analysis system determines that all three candidate languages have confidence scores that meet a predefined threshold. The language analysis system **134** searches in individual databases associated with each of Spanish, English and Italian languages to find matching game related information related to the term “tycoon” and “pizza.” A match score is determined for each response match in the respective language-specific databases. The response score is based on the certainty of the database match. Search results to be included in a response is determined, based, at least in part, on weighted scores of the combined confidence score and response scores for the individual response matches. In addition, the player has a user profile associated with the online gaming platform that lists Spanish as a preferred language for her. Such user information may also be factored to boost the ranking of search results from the Spanish database in the response provided to the player.

(20) The gaming platform device retrieves several games from the Spanish database that include the word, “tycoon” or “magnate” and the word “pizza” in the game title, or that otherwise relate to pizza business ownership. The search results of the matched games are transmitted through network **122** client computing device **102** and appear as selectable icons **116** on the display screen **106** of the client computing device **102**. The search results are displayed in an order consistent with the weighted scores and relationship to the user query. From the player's perspective, the results of her search query are instantaneously received. On the user interface **104**, the player clicks on one of the icons **116** for the game she chooses to play and a link connects her to a webpage to play the game.

(21) Example Pre-Processing Training Data

(22) FIG. 2 shows by way of a block diagram of a data processing device **200**, such as the game server **130** shown in FIG. 1, for pre-processing text data performed by one or more processors **242** of the data processing device **200**. Text data is adapted for training the machine learning model in an online gaming context.

(23) In some implementations, the data processing device **200** may be a separate computer from the game server **130**. In this case, the processed training data may be used by the data processing device **200** for training the machine learning model **136** and then transmitted by the data processing device **200** to the game server **130** or to another intermediary computing device for training the machine learning model **136**. The techniques employed by the data processing device **200** are used to generate training text data in preparation for training the machine learning model **136** to determine a language of a user query.

(24) In some implementations, more than one machine learning model **136** may be trained with at least a portion of the training text data. In some implementations various types of text data are used

for training multiple machine learning models. The machine learning models may be evaluated and a machine learning model may be chosen for a particular user query, such as evaluating for accuracy and relevance to a user query.

(25) The text data may include various types of collections of text data **202** received from different sources by data processing device **200** at an input/output interface **222**. The text collections **202** may be in different languages or may be a single collection that may include a mix of languages.

(26) The text collections **202** may include text data having prior existing labels that specify the language of the text, such as pre-labeled expansive text data **208** and pre-labeled game-related text data **210**. Pre-labeled expansive text data **208**, for example, may include voluminous publicly available corpuses, such as multilingual text corpuses that may be translated into many languages and dialects, e.g. hundreds of languages. Multilingual text corpuses may include online encyclopedias, e.g. Wikipedia's in various languages (www.wikipedia.org), which data may also be accessed through a Wikipedia Application Programming Interface (API). Multilingual text corpuses may also include international historical documents, e.g. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (<https://www.ohchr.org/EN/UDHR/Pages/UDHRIndex.aspx>). Some pre-labeled text data may have prior language labels validated by label validator **226**.

(27) The label validator **226** provides an indication of whether the pre-existing language labels of the pre-labeled text data are correct or incorrect. The label validator may assist in strengthening accuracy of labels, for example, in the case that there is not adequate confidence in a pre-existing language label for given text data. For example, a text collection may include a majority of text in one language, but also include words in other languages (e.g., names, etc.). The label validator **226** may employ multiple non-specific language detectors, e.g. publicly available libraries, to detect language with a minimum threshold consensus in the languages indicated by the non-specific language detectors. Non-specific language detectors may use language detection models and/or language libraries, including any combination of open source, paid services, previous versions of models generated by the online game system, and other language detection models and language libraries. In some implementations, a minimum confidence threshold may be adjusted to be lower for pre-labeled text data that originate with more confident language labels. Input pre-labeled text data strings with consensus between the pre-existing label and the language determined by a threshold number of the non-specific language detectors, may be added to the training dataset. If the non-specific language detectors fail to detect a same language to the confidence threshold level for a given pre-existing label, the pre-labeled text data may be excluded from the training data.

(28) Game-related text data **210** may include various text associated with online games, such as game titles, game instructions, text displayed to players as part of a game, game descriptions, common user search queries in online gaming platforms, common chat messages in online gaming platforms, typical slang terms related to online games, etc. In some implementations, game-related text data **210** is selected from online line games that meet a popularity threshold and/or ranking. Game-related data may be predominately in a particular language, e.g. English, and include manually added labels in the predominate language. Game developers may associate language labels to the text related to a game. However, manually labeled text data may lack reliability and the labels may be assessed by label validator **226**. Machine translation may also be applied to such text data to translate game-related data and associate languages labels, especially for text data in obscure languages. This may provide additional training data in languages where an existing corpus of training data may be limited in number of available data samples.

(29) Text collections **202** may also include text data without prior existing language labels, such as unlabeled abbreviated text data **210** and unlabeled expansive text data **206**, for example, descriptions of online games.

(30) Unlabeled text data may have language labels created and associated with the text data by auto labeler **224**. The collections of text data may include game-related data, such as game titles, chat texts, game source data, slang terms, and other text common to online gaming. The auto labeler **224**

may employ a plurality of non-specific language detectors using multiple language detection models and language libraries to detect a language of a given text data string to accumulate a large set of training data. These models and library corpuses may be any combination of open source, paid services, previous versions of models generated by the online game system, and other language detection models and language libraries. A language determination by any of the non-specific language detectors may need to meet a confidence threshold to be considered for auto labeling. For each unlabeled text data strings inputted into the auto labeler **224**, a language label is associated with the text data if a threshold number of the non-specific language detectors identify a same language with a minimum confidence threshold. For example, if there is language prediction consensus from all the language detectors with a configurable high level (e.g. threshold) of confidence, the label and text may be included for training data. If the non-specific language detectors fail to detect a same language to the confidence threshold level for a given unlabeled text data string, the unlabeled text data may be excluded from the training data.

(31) The text data may also include word strings of a length that is greater than an upper threshold length. For example, publicly available corpuses may include very long sentences and paragraphs. Expansive text collections may include, for example, pre-labeled expansive text data **208** and unlabeled expansive text data **206**. By contrast, user queries for online gaming platforms may be short word strings. In order to make the expansive text collections relevant to such short user queries, the strings of expansive text collection may be randomized to a reduced length to be similar to the length of typical user query strings. The expansive text data may be split by text splitter **230** to random word length strings, such as strings with 1 to 5 words.

(32) Abbreviated text data **204**, such as unlabeled abbreviated text data **204** may have word strings that are shorter in length than a low threshold length, such as 1 to 5 words. Examples of abbreviated text data may include stored chat texts and prior search queries that were previously utilized in the game platform. Short text strings can be difficult to detect in order to auto label the text data or validate pre-labels. Abbreviated text data may be aggregated by text merger **228**. The abbreviated text data strings may be aggregated according to a shared characteristic of the text strings, such as text data authored by a common user or other common factors, to create longer strings that allow for easier auto labeling.

(33) Text data may be broken into n-gram characters by an n-gram separator **232** to create processed training data **236**. The n-gram characters may include a specified number of characters, such as one character (unigrams), two characters (bigrams), three characters (trigrams), etc. For example, a text data word string “A tycoon” may be broken into “A”, “A t”, “A ty”, “Ty”, and “Tyc,” etc. The n-gram characters are used as features for training the machine learning model.

(34) The training data may be in the format of feature vectors containing values, e.g. numbers, that represent each feature. In addition to n-gram features, other features may be extracted from the text data and included as training data, which may be in the format of feature vectors, such as counts or existence of characters in different Unicode blocks, Unicode scripts, specific combinations of these, etc. For example n-gram feature vectors may include values in the form of 1's and 0's indicating that a particular n-gram exists in the input text, counts of the number of times the n-gram appears in the input text, etc.

(35) The processed training data **236** in the form of n-grams may be saved in memory **234** and fed into the training module **240** as features to train the machine learning model. For example, a 3-gram character sequence “ity” may be input to the machine learning model as a fragment pattern.

(36) In some implementations, the n-gram characters used as features for in training the machine learning model may include ASCII characters, Korean characters, Japanese characters, Russian characters, Latin characters, Cyrillic characters, or blocks of Unicode.

(37) The language labels associated with the processed text data, such as the language labels by auto labeler **224**, by label validator **226**, and trusted pre-labels, may be utilized as ground truth labels for purposes of training the machine learning model.

(38) Example Training Machine Learning Model

(39) An example method to train a machine learning model for the language analysis system is shown in the flowchart in FIG. 3. In some implementations, the techniques to train the machine learning model may employ supervised classification algorithms, such as logistic regression algorithms using the n-gram features described with regard to FIG. 1, and counts of different character types in the n-grams. The most common n-grams across languages and within languages may be used as features. The processed training data and associated language labels, such as the ground truth language labels described with regard to FIG. 1, are received for training in block 300. In some implementations, the computing device that processes the training data and associated language labels may be separate from the computing device that is utilized for training of the machine learning model. In some implementations, the same computing device is used to perform the processing of training data and associated language labels as well as training of the machine learning model.

(40) In block 302, the processed training data may be fed into an untrained machine learning model without the associated language labels for supervised training. In some implementations, the processed training data may be fed into an untrained machine learning model with the associated language labels for unsupervised training. In some implementations, the training data is in the form of feature vectors. Processed training data may be selected for training if the training data meets certain pre-defined factors. For example, the most common n-grams across languages and/or within particular languages may be used as features for training.

(41) In block 304, the machine learning model analyzes the training text data and generates predicted language as output data, as described herein.

(42) In block 306, the current predicted language labels are compared with language labels that are associated with the training data prior to the training, such as the language labels from the pre-processing of the training data. Discrepancy information is generated that is indicative of the difference between the predicted labels and the previously associated labels. In decision block 308, it may be determined if the discrepancy information meets a pre-defined threshold for the accuracy of the predicted language labels. If the threshold accuracy is not met, in block 310, the discrepancy information is fed back to the machine learning model to retrain the machine learning model and update the current predicted language labels. The process returns to block 304 for the machine learning model to re-determine and output predicted labels. The retraining may be iteratively repeated using additional training datasets until the discrepancy meets a threshold of accuracy. If threshold accuracy is met, in block 312 the process accepts the machine learning model as ready to evaluate a user query.

(43) In some implementations, more than one machine learning model may be trained with different training data. A machine learning repository may be provided to store and retrieve the trained machine learning models, including associated data and/or metadata. One or more of the trained machine learning models may be selected to evaluate an incoming user query. The machine learning repositories enable flexibility in using any version of the model at any time, or use different models on different parts of the text being evaluated.

(44) Although the steps, operations, or computations may be presented in a specific order, the order may be changed in particular implementations. Other orderings of the steps are possible, depending on the particular implementation. In some particular implementations, multiple steps shown as sequential in this specification may be performed at the same time. Also, some implementations may not have all of the steps shown and/or may have other steps instead of, or in addition to, those shown herein.

(45) Example User Query Response

(46) An example method to evaluate a user query by applying the machine learning model is shown in the flowchart in FIG. 4. The techniques include determining a language of the user query and responding to the user query.

(47) In block **400**, the user query is received by the system. The user query may be entered by a user through various input ways, such as entering text through a keyboard. In some implementations, the user query may be initiated as voice input, such as through a microphone, by the user. The user query entered as audio may be converted to text. The input may include a user applying touch, voice, click, tap, type, gesture, movement (e.g. moving an eye, arm, body), and/or other actions.

(48) In block **402** the user query may be processed for evaluation. For example, the user query may be separated into n-grams, which may be performed in a manner similar to the processing of the training data by n-gram separator described with regard to FIG. 2.

(49) In block **404**, the trained machine learning model is utilized to identify candidate languages for the user query. It may be determined using the machine learning model that certain n-gram segments of the processed user query are common and/or have meaning in particular languages, which are identified as candidate languages. For example, a 3-gram segment, “ity” of a user query may be found to be common in both English and French languages.

(50) In some implementations, a candidate language may include an unknown language category in instances where a language of a user query is unidentified by the trained machine learning model.

(51) In block **406** the machine learning model is applied to determine confidence scores for each of the candidate languages. In some implementations, the confidence scores indicate a degree of relevance of segments of the n-grams to the candidate language. A minimum threshold score for each candidate language may be returned by the machine learning model. Any language that returns a score over a minimum threshold is returned as a possible candidate language.

(52) In block **408** language databases that are specific to the individually named candidate languages are searched to find matches with the words of the user query in its unprocessed form. The language-specific databases include game information associated with the response matches. Language-specific databases of candidate languages that meet pre-defined searching criteria may be searched. In some implementations, candidate languages may be ranked according to the respective candidate scores. Language-specific databases for the top designated number of ranked languages may be searched. In some implementations, language-specific databases of candidate languages that meet a threshold confidence score are used in the search.

(53) In some implementations, a vector that includes scores for multiple languages is generated, and multiple language specific databases corresponding to the scores are searched based on the user query. A consolidated score that is based on the confidence score for the language and the score for the user query in each of the languages is generated. For example, for a given search query, the machine learning model may output a score for each language. Languages that are associated with confidence scores over a threshold may be used for searching. The confidence score for each language may also be used as a factor in the overall scoring and/or sorting of responses (e.g. online games) returned from the search query from each language database.

(54) In some implementations, additional consideration factors may be used to boost or demote a confidence score, including user-specific information related to one or more languages. User-specific information may include user profile information, for example, language preferences specified by the user and may include user activity statistics, for example, data representing prior languages used by the user and/or languages of prior games played by the user. Such additional factors may be considered in determining a language-specific database to search. For example, a particular language indicated by the additional consideration factors, e.g., the user-specific information, may have a boost value that adds to a confidence score, or a demote value that subtracts from a confidence score. A resulting boosted score of a particular language may reach a confidence threshold or ranking, even if the confidence score without the boost value fails to meet a threshold or ranking criteria. A demoted score may remove a particular language even if the confidence score without the demote value meets a threshold or ranking criteria. A language-specific database of a language with a boosted score that meets the searching criteria may be

searched.

(55) In some implementations, additional consideration factors, e.g., user-specific information, are considered as separate criteria from a confidence score. For example, a language listed in a user profile may be a candidate language in addition to the candidate languages found by the machine learning model. Language-specific databases for languages indicated by the additional consideration factors, e.g., user-specific information, may be also searched.

(56) In a circumstance in which a candidate language is an unidentified language by the machine learning model, a language-specific database associated with unknown languages may be searched for response matches. In some implementations, an unknown language database is searched by default along with language-specific databases related to determined query languages.

(57) In some implementations, prior to searching in the identified language-specific databases, the user query may be processed to adapt to search requirements and practices of a particular candidate language-specific database. For example, where a language does not recognize or consider a certain word, (such as the words “the” and “a”) for searches, the word may be dropped as a search term in that language-specific database. In another example, the use of spaces between words or sentences may be modified to meet the conventions of a language.

(58) Some words may be valid words in multiple languages. For example, a user query that includes keywords, “pizza place” may result in English and Italian language results. In another example, a user query that includes the term “lava” may result in a finding of at least English, Croatian, Czech, Danish, Dutch, German, Norwegian, and Spanish languages.

(59) In block **410** match scores are determined for each response match in the language specific databases. The match scores indicate a measure of closeness of the matches of the user query to stored user queries in particular languages in the language-specific databases. For example, a match score may be based on the number or percentage of words in a query that have an exact match in a language-specific database. In some implementations, the match score may represent the character match of the words in a user query with words in a language-specific database. In some implementations, other standard relevance scoring techniques may be employed, such as Terms Frequency-Inverse Document Frequency methods (TF-IDF) and Bag of Words retrieval functions (Best Matching-BM25).

(60) In block **412** a weighted score is determined from the confidence score and the match score of a language. Each result may have two scores associated with it, a confidence score from the machine learning model and a match score from language databases, which may be a combination of multiple scores from matching in various language databases. One of the match score or confidence score, may be used to boost or demote the other score by associating weights to the two scores, resulting in the weighted score.

(61) In some implementations, the scores may be normalized between databases to more accurately compare matches. For example, match scores in a particular language database may be high because there are fewer search hits or less entries in the database as compared to another language database that includes more search hits. Normalizing the data within the databases may provide more accurate match scores.

(62) In block **414** the response matches are ranked according to the weighted score. Additional consideration factors may be applied to boost or demote a ranking. In block **416**, search results to be provided in a response are determined based, at least in part, on the ranking of the response matches, as illustrated below.

(63) In some implementations, user-specific information may be considered to boost the determination in favor of a particular query language or demote the determination against a particular query language. Some examples of user-specific information include user profile information, amount of player engagement with games of a particular language, and amount that a player interacts with online games using a particular language, e.g. prior user queries, chats, text, etc.

(64) To illustrate, a confidence score for a particular search query, for example, may be 90% for French and 60% for Spanish based on the machine learning model output. A top three matches in a French database have match scores of 500 (F1), 450 (F2), and 200 (F3) respectively, and a top three matches in a Spanish database have match scores of 750 (S1), 400 (S2) and 250 (S3), respectively. In this example, weighted scores for the French matches may be 450 (F1), 405 (F2), and 180 (F3), respectively. The weighted scores for the Spanish matches may be 450 (S1), 240 (S2), and 72 (S3). The ranking order according to the weighted scores may be F1 and S1, F2, S2, F3, and S3. In this example, a ranking threshold may be provided to provide as a search result, the top pre-defined number of matches, such as the matches having the top four weighted scores, or to provide matches with a weighted score over a predefined value, such as 200. In either case, the response to the user may be provided in the order of the ranking: F1 and S1, F2, and S2. In addition, other consideration factors may be applied to boost or demote the weighted scores, especially to break the tied weighted scores of F1 and S1. For example, if a user profile or previous user experience is in French, then F1 may be ranked prior to S1 in the response. In some implementations, only highest ranking search results that are consistent with consideration factors, e.g. user profile, may be provided in the response.

(65) In block **418** a response that includes search results to the user query is surfaced for the user. The response may be based on game information identified by the response matches in the language-specific databases for the potential query languages. For example, the identified game information may be included in the search result response or otherwise referenced to create the response.

(66) To provide a search result response, the game information may be aggregated and ranked. In some instances, the same search results, e.g. online games, may appear in multiple language databases. If duplicate search results are obtained, the system may dedupe the results using logic. For example, identical or substantially similar results may be filtered out to remove the duplicates. In some implementations, when a same search result is found in multiple language databases, the system may choose the duplicate search result, e.g. game, from the language-specific database having a highest weighted score to be presented to the client device in the search result response.

(67) Some game information listed in a language-specific database may not be reliably categorized as a particular language. The game information may be manually categorized as a language, for example, by a game developer and may be inaccurate. A listing of game information for a particular language may be validated by reference to supplemental language information, such as game statistics and user profile languages for users who access a game associated with the game information. In some implementations, a game database may be seeded for a language based on supplemental language information, such as an amount of player traffic in a particular language in a game, such as indicated by user profile language information of players of the game.

(68) In some implementations, game information may include connect information such as webpage information, e.g., a Uniform Resource Locator (URL) for an online game or information for launching a game application. For example, a search result response may include one or more user interface elements, such as icons. The interface element, e.g. a link, may be activated by a user action, such as clicking, tapping, keyboard action, voice command, etc. to navigate to digital information, e.g. a webpage, an application, etc., associated with playing a respective one of the online games. In this manner, a user may connect to an online game and play the game or receive descriptive information about the game, such as certain players or player groups, virtual items for use in the game, e.g. avatar parts, clothing, and accessories, and game developer tools, e.g. packages, decals, audio, and plugins. For example, the digital information may be a start webpage to begin playing a particular game.

(69) Although the steps, operations, or computations may be presented in a specific order, the order may be changed in particular implementations. Other orderings of the steps are possible, depending on the particular implementation. In some particular implementations, multiple steps shown as

sequential in this specification may be performed at the same time. Also, some implementations may not have all of the steps shown and/or may have other steps instead of, or in addition to, those shown herein.

(70) Example Game Server

(71) FIG. 5 is a block diagram that shows example elements of a game server **500** of the online game system, such as the game server **130** shown in FIG. 1. The game server **500** may analyze a user query and provide a search result response, for example using the method described with regard to FIG. 4. Specifically, game server **500** may be a sub-system of an overall system architecture (shown and described in more detail with respect to FIG. 6).

(72) The various elements of the game server **500** are shown in FIG. 5 as discrete/separate elements for purposes of illustration and explanation. According to some embodiments, it is possible to combine some of these elements into a single element or device, while in other implementations of the online game system, these elements may be distributed across a network such as in a cloud computing network. For example, in a multiple server implementation, elements associated with the language analysis system **504** may be located and operated at one server, while elements associated with query evaluator **506** may be located at another server remote from the first server.

(73) The game server **500** may include memory **502**, processor **520**, and I/O interface **530**. Memory **502** may include language analysis system **504** (such as language analysis system **134** described with reference to FIG. 1), search engine **506** (such as search engine **138** described with reference to FIG. 1), data storage **508**, computer program(s) **510**, and/or operating system **512**.

(74) I/O interface **530** can provide functions to enable interfacing the game server **500** with other systems and devices, such as servers over a wireless network, such as network **122** described with regard to FIG. 1. Interfaced devices can be included as part of the game server **500** or can be separate and communicate with the game server **500**. In some implementations, network communication devices, storage devices (e.g., memory and/or databases), and input/output devices can communicate via I/O interface **530**.

(75) The I/O interface **530** can interface to other input and output devices. In some implementations, the I/O interface **530** can connect to interface devices such as input devices (keyboard, pointing device, touchscreen, microphone, camera, scanner, sensors, etc.) and/or output devices (display devices, speaker devices, printers, motors, etc.). Some implementations can provide a microphone for capturing sound (e.g., as a part of captured images, voice commands, etc.), audio speaker devices for outputting sound, or other input and output devices.

(76) The processor **520** (such as processor **140** described with regard to FIG. 1) may process instruction for execution within the game server **500** including instructions stored in memory **502** or on the data store **508**. The processor **520** may coordinate computing device components, e.g. applications, wireless or wired communication through interfaces, etc. In some implementations, multiple processors and buses may be used.

(77) The processor **520** may be implemented as a chipset of chips that include separate and multiple analog digital processors. The processor may also be implemented using various architectures. For example, the processor **520** may be a CISC (Complex Instruction Set Computer) processor, RISC (Reduced Instruction Set Computer) processor or MISC (Minimal Instruction Set Computer) processor.

(78) A “processor” includes any suitable hardware and/or software system, mechanism or component that processes data, signals or other information. A processor may include a system with a general-purpose central processing unit, multiple processing units, dedicated circuitry for achieving functionality, or other systems. Processing need not be limited to a geographic location, or have temporal limitations. For example, a processor may perform its functions in “real-time,” “offline,” in a “batch mode,” etc. Portions of processing may be performed at different times and at different locations, by different (or the same) processing systems.

(79) The memory **502** stores information within the game server **500**. The memory **502** may be any

suitable data storage, memory and/or non-transitory computer-readable storage media, including electronic storage devices such as random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), magnetic storage device (hard disk drive or the like), flash, optical storage device (CD, DVD or the like), magnetic or optical disk, or other tangible media suitable for storing instructions (e.g., program or software instructions) for execution by the processor. For example, a tangible medium such as a hardware storage device can be used to store the control logic, which can include executable instructions. The instructions can also be contained in, and provided as, an electronic signal, for example in the form of software as a service (SaaS) delivered from a server (e.g., a distributed system and/or a cloud computing system).

(80) Data store **508** may keep training data, pre-processed text data, applications, and other data. Data store may also be employed to store the original image as well as various edited versions of the image. At least a portion of the information may also be stored on a disk drive or other computer readable storage device (not shown) within the game server **500**. Such storage device include a floppy disk device, a hard disk device, an optical disk device, or a tape device, digital cards, a flash memory or other similar solid state memory device, or an array of devices. In some implementations, data storage **508** includes a machine learning repository **514** for aggregating, updating, managing and retrieving the trained machine learning models.

(81) One or more computer programs **510**, also referred to as programs, software, software applications or code, may also contain instructions that, when executed, perform one or more methods, such as those described herein. The computer program may be tangibly embodied in an information carrier such as computer or machine readable medium, for example, the memory **502**, storage device or memory on processor **520**. A machine readable medium is any computer program product, apparatus or device used to provide machine instructions or data to a programmable processor.

(82) Any suitable programming languages and programming techniques may be used to implement the routines of particular embodiments. Different programming techniques may be employed such as procedural or object-oriented. The routines may execute on a single processing device or multiple processors. Although the steps, operations, or computations may be presented in a specific order, the order may be changed in different particular embodiments. In some particular embodiments, multiple steps shown as sequential in this specification may be performed at the same time. A number of implementations have been described. Features described with conditional language may describe implementations that are optional. The functional blocks, methods, devices, and systems described in the present disclosure may be integrated or divided into different combinations of systems, devices, and functional blocks as would be known to those skilled in the art.

(83) Although the description has been described with respect to particular implementations thereof, these particular implementations are merely illustrative, and not restrictive. Concepts illustrated in the examples may be applied to other examples and implementations. Thus, various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of this disclosure and other implementations are within the scope of the following claims.

(84) Methods described herein can be implemented by computer program instructions or code, which can be executed on a computer. In some implementations, the code can be implemented by one or more digital processors (e.g., microprocessors or other processing circuitry) and can be stored on a computer program product including a non-transitory computer readable medium (e.g., storage medium), such as a magnetic, optical, electromagnetic, or semiconductor storage medium, including semiconductor or solid state memory, magnetic tape, a removable computer diskette, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), flash memory, a rigid magnetic disk, an optical disk, a solid-state memory drive, etc. The program instructions can also be contained in, and provided as, an electronic signal, for example in the form of software as a service (SaaS) delivered from a server (e.g., a distributed system and/or a cloud computing system).

(85) Alternatively, one or more methods can be implemented in hardware (logic gates, etc.), or in a combination of hardware and software. Example hardware can be programmable processors (e.g. Field-Programmable Gate Array (FPGA), Complex Programmable Logic Device), general purpose processors, graphics processing units (GPUS), Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), and the like. One or more methods can be performed as part of or component of an application running on the system, or as an application or software running in conjunction with other applications **512** and operating system **514**.

(86) Example System Architecture

(87) In FIG. **6**, an example game system architecture **600** (also referred to as “system” herein) includes a game server **602** (for example, game server **500** described with regard to FIG. **5**), a first client computing device **A 610**, and at least one other client computing device **N 616** (where “N” represents any number of one or more client devices).

(88) The game server **602** may include the language analysis system **604** (such as language analysis system **134** described with regard to FIG. **1**) and one or more online games **606**. The game server **602** may also include a game management module **608** to provide search result responses to client devices **610** and **616** and manage client access to online games **606**. The game server **602** may be operatively coupled to or otherwise in communication with storage **624**. The system architecture **600** is provided for illustration of one possible implementation. In other implementations, the game system architecture **600** may include the same, fewer, more, or different elements configured in the same or different manner as that shown in FIG. **6**.

(89) A communication network **622** (such as network **122** described with regard to FIG. **1**) may be used for communication between the game server **602** and the client devices **610**, **616**, and/or between other elements in the game system architecture **600**. The network **622** may include a public network (e.g., the Internet), a private network (e.g., a local area network (LAN) or wide area network (WAN)), a wired network (e.g., Ethernet network), a wireless network (e.g., an 802.11 network, a Wi-Fi network, or wireless LAN (WLAN)), a cellular network (e.g., a long term evolution (LTE) network), routers, hubs, switches, server computers, or a combination thereof.

(90) The client devices **610**, **616**, such as a personal computer, mobile device, or video game console, may include a game application **612**, **620** and one or more input/output devices **614**, **618** (e.g., audio/video input/output devices) to input user queries from the user and receive query results from game server **602**. The input/output devices **614**, **618** can interface to other input and output devices. In some implementations, the input/output devices **614**, **618** can connect to interface devices such as input devices (keyboard, pointing device, touchscreen, microphone, camera, scanner, sensors, etc.) and/or output devices (display devices, speaker devices, printers, headphones etc.). Some implementations can provide a microphone for capturing sound (e.g. voice commands), audio speaker devices for outputting sound (e.g. search result responses), or other input and output devices.

(91) The game system architecture **600** may further include one or more storage devices **624**. The storage device **624** may be, for example, a storage device located within the game server **602** or communicatively coupled to the game server **602** via the network **622**. The storage device **604** may store, for example, training text data, unprocessed text data, user-specific information, e.g. user profile information, trained machine learning models such as in a machine learning model repository (e.g., **514** of FIG. **5**), language-specific databases, etc.

(92) In one implementation, the storage device **624** may be a non-transitory computer readable memory (e.g., random access memory), a cache, a drive (e.g., a hard drive), a flash drive, a database system, or another type of component or device capable of storing data and other content. The storage device **624** may also include multiple storage components (e.g., multiple drives or multiple databases) that may also span multiple computing devices (e.g., multiple server computers).

(93) In one implementation, the storage device **624** may be a non-transitory computer readable

memory (e.g., random access memory), a cache, a drive (e.g., a hard drive), a flash drive, a database system, or another type of component or device capable of storing data and other content. The storage device **624** may also include multiple storage components (e.g., multiple drives or multiple databases) that may also span multiple computing devices (e.g., multiple server computers).

(94) In some implementations, the game server **602** may include a server having one or more computing devices (e.g., a cloud computing system, a rackmount server, a server computer, cluster of physical servers, etc.). In some implementations, the game server **602** may be included in the online gaming platform **402**, be an independent system, or be part of another system or platform.

(95) In some implementations, the game server **602** may include one or more computing devices (such as a rackmount server, a router computer, a server computer, a personal computer, a mainframe computer, a laptop computer, a tablet computer, a desktop computer, etc.), data stores (e.g., hard disks, memories, databases), networks, software components, and/or hardware components that may be used to perform operations on the game server **602** and to provide a user with access to game server **602**. The game server **602** may also include a website (e.g., a webpage) or application back-end software that may be used to provide a user with access to content provided by game server **602**. For example, a user may access game server **602** using the game application **612** on the client device A **610** and game application **620** on client device N **616**.

(96) In some implementations, game server **602** may be a type of social network providing connections between users or a type of user-generated content system that allows users (e.g., end-users or consumers) to communicate with other users on the online gaming platform **402**, where the communication may include voice chat (e.g., synchronous and/or asynchronous voice communication), video chat (e.g., synchronous and/or asynchronous video communication), or text chat (e.g., synchronous and/or asynchronous text-based communication).

(97) In some implementations of the disclosure, a “user” may be represented as a single individual. However, other implementations of the disclosure encompass a “user” being an entity controlled by a set of users or an automated source. For example, a set of individual users federated as a community or group in a user-generated content system may be considered a “user.”

(98) In some implementations, online gaming platform **602** may be a virtual gaming platform. For example, the gaming platform may provide single-player or multiplayer games to a community of users that may access or interact with games using client devices **610**, **616** via the network **622**. In some implementations, games (also referred to as “video game,” “online game,” or “virtual game” etc. herein) may be two-dimensional (2D) games, three-dimensional (3D) games (e.g., 3D user-generated games), virtual reality (VR) games, or augmented reality (AR) games, for example. In some implementations, users may participate in gameplay with other users. In some implementations, a game may be played in real-time with other users of the game.

(99) In some implementations, gameplay may refer to interaction of one or more players using client devices (e.g., the client device **610** and/or **616**) within a game (e.g., the game **606**) or the presentation of the interaction on a display or other user interfaces (e.g., the user interface **614**, **618**) of client devices **610**, **616**.

(100) In some implementations, the game **606** can include an electronic file that can be executed or loaded using software, firmware or hardware configured to present the game content (e.g., digital media item) to an entity. In some implementations, the game application **612**, **620** may be executed and the game(s) **606** rendered in connection with the game server **60s**.

(101) Reference to “some implementations” or “some instances,” as used above, means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the implementations or instances can be included in at least one implementation of the description. The appearances of the phrase “in some implementations” in various places above, are not necessarily referring to the same implementations.

(102) In the above detailed description, reference is made to the accompanying drawings, which

form a part hereof. In the drawings, similar symbols typically identify similar components, unless context dictates otherwise. The illustrative implementations described in the detailed description, drawings, and claims are not meant to be limiting. Other implementations may be utilized, and other changes may be made, without departing from the spirit or scope of the subject matter presented herein. Aspects of the present disclosure, as generally described herein, and illustrated in the Figures, can be arranged, substituted, combined, separated, and designed in a wide variety of different configurations, all of which are contemplated herein.

(103) In the above description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the specification. It will be apparent, however, to one skilled in the art that the disclosure can be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring the description. For example, the implementations can be described above primarily with reference to particular hardware. However, the implementations can apply to any type of computing device that can receive data and commands, and any peripheral devices providing services.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method, comprising: parsing a user query into n-grams; identifying, with a machine-learning model, candidate languages for the user query and respective confidence scores for the candidate languages based on the n-grams from the user query, wherein the machine learning model is trained based on at least one multilingual text corpus and game-related data; identifying one or more response matches to the user query in language-specific game databases and one or more respective match scores for the one or more response matches, wherein each response match is in a respective language of the candidate languages; determining a weighted score for each of the one or more response matches by weighting the one or more respective match scores based on a respective confidence score for the respective language of a respective response match; and providing a response of search results including game information associated with particular response matches, based, at least in part, on the respective weighted score.
2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein identifying the candidate languages further comprises identifying at least one language from a user profile associated with the user query.
3. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising deduplicating the search results prior to providing the response.
4. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, further comprising prior to identifying the one or more response matches, pre-processing the user query to adapt to search requirements of the language-specific game databases.
5. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein determining the weighted score comprises boosting or demoting the one or more respective match scores based on the respective confidence score for the respective language.
6. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the candidate languages for the user query further include an undetermined language.
7. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein determining the weighted score comprises boosting or demoting each of the one or more response matches based on user-specific information related to at least one of the candidate languages.
8. The computer-implemented method of claim 7, wherein the user query is associated with a user associated with a user profile, and wherein the user-specific information comprises one or more of: language preferences specified in the user profile, user activity statistics, or languages of prior games used by the user.
9. The computer-implemented method of claim 8, wherein identifying the candidate languages further comprises identifying one or more languages from the language preferences specified in the

user profile.

10. The computer-implemented method of claim 7, further comprising: identifying the one or more language-specific game databases based on the user-specific information.

11. A system comprising: a memory with instructions stored thereon; and a processing device, coupled to the memory and operable to access the memory, wherein the instructions when executed by the processing device, cause the processing device to perform operations including: parsing a user query into n-grams; identifying, with a machine-learning model, candidate languages for the user query and respective confidence scores for the candidate languages based on the n-grams from the user query, wherein the machine learning model is trained based on at least one multilingual text corpus and game-related data; identifying one or more response matches to the user query in language-specific game databases and one or more respective match scores for the one or more response matches, wherein each response match is in a respective language of the candidate languages; determining a weighted score for each of the one or more response matches by weighting the one or more respective match scores based on a respective confidence score for the respective language of a respective response match; and providing a response of search results including game information associated with particular response matches, based, at least in part, on the respective weighted score.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein identifying the candidate languages further comprises identifying at least one language from a user profile associated with the user query.

13. The system of claim 11, wherein the operations further comprise deduplicating the search results prior to providing the response.

14. The system of claim 11, wherein the operations further comprise prior to identifying the one or more response matches, pre-processing the user query to adapt to search requirements of the language-specific game databases.

15. The system of claim 11, wherein determining the weighted score comprises boosting or demoting the one or more match respective scores based on the respective confidence score for the respective language.

16. The system of claim 11, wherein the candidate languages for the user query further include an undetermined language.

17. The system of claim 11, wherein determining the weighted score comprises boosting or demoting each of the one or more response matches based on user-specific information related to at least one of the candidate languages.

18. The system of claim 17, wherein the user-specific information comprises one or more of: language preferences specified by a user, user activity statistics, or languages of prior games used by a user.

19. The system of claim 18, wherein identifying the candidate languages further comprises identifying the one or more languages from the language preferences specified by the user.

20. A non-transitory computer-readable medium with instructions stored thereon that, responsive to execution by a processing device, causes the processing device to perform operations comprising: parsing a user query into n-grams; identifying, with a machine-learning model, candidate languages for the user query and respective confidence scores for the candidate languages based on the n-grams from the user query, wherein the machine learning model is trained based on at least one multilingual text corpus and game-related data; identifying one or more response matches to the user query in language-specific game databases and one or more respective match scores for the one or more response matches, wherein each response match is in a respective language of the candidate languages; determining a weighted score for each of the response matches by weighting the one or more respective match scores based on a respective confidence score for the respective language of a respective response match; and providing a response of search results including game information associated with particular response matches, based, at least in part, on the respective weighted score.

